

Syed Zaid Ali

BACKEND ENGINEER | FINTECH | AI ACCOUNTING

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[LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Medium](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend Engineer with 4+ years building scalable REST APIs, distributed systems, and high-volume payment platforms for FinTech and AI products. Hands-on with Python, Django, FastAPI, Rust, Actix, SQL, Redis, AWS, and Azure; experienced in system design, data modeling, event-driven architecture, high availability, observability, operational excellence, and production ownership.

SELECTED ENGINEERING IMPACT

- Modernized the MDS API layer with thin HTTP boundaries, service-owned query orchestration, standardized REST contracts, and feature-flagged rollout.
- Reduced a measured bank-statement request from 26 to 10 database queries through batching and query optimization; set a default cursor-paginated page size of 20.
- Validated high-traffic behavior at 500 concurrent users with zero failures, supported by repeatable load-test reporting, Swagger documentation, and Postman flows.

EXPERIENCE

SDE II | Karbon Business | Oct 2024 - Present

- Led engineering ownership of a product revamp and service rewrite, improving high availability, scalability, maintainability, observability, and release quality.
- Released Multi-user Flow, Journal Voucher Flow, Billing Module, and SSO + OAuth 2.0 with authentication and authorization controls.
- Spearheaded FinBox bank-statement ingestion across PDF, Excel, and images; reduced manual effort 70%, achieved 98% accuracy, and improved onboarding 40%.
- Built real-time Tally APIs and a Windows connector for bi-directional AP, AR, and journal-voucher sync with idempotency, retries, and reconciliation; drove 3x adoption across 500+ users.
- Redesigned Django service boundaries and REST API contracts; added Swagger documentation, Postman validation flows, positive and negative API tests, and feature-flagged rollout controls.
- Optimized database access for high throughput, standardized cursor pagination, and profiled connection behavior under concurrency to improve production readiness.
- Led incident response for critical onboarding services, cutting recovery time 95%; raised automated test coverage to 80% and reduced failures 50%.

Backend Engineer | Juspay | Sep 2022 - May 2024

- Owned system design and production operations for reconciliation microservices processing millions of payment transactions daily.
- Led service refactoring that improved maintainability and engineering efficiency by 40%, strengthening modularity, testability, and release confidence.
- Built reusable APIs, cron jobs, ETL pipelines, and merchant integrations for automated reconciliation and financial-data workflows.
- Reduced integration latency by 30% through API design, performance optimization, and cross-functional delivery.
- Built CI/CD automation with Docker and Jenkins, accelerating releases 50% while keeping production downtime below 1%.

Technical Product Analyst Intern | Juspay | Feb 2022 - Aug 2022

- Architected a Kafka-based real-time logging pipeline and Kibana-style monitoring dashboard, strengthening observability and operational insight.
- Used customer feedback to accelerate product iterations 25% and improved data-collection accuracy to 95%.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & APIs: Python, Rust, Actix, Django, FastAPI, REST APIs | **Data:** PostgreSQL, SQL, Redis, BigQuery, ClickHouse, ETL
Architecture & reliability: Distributed systems, microservices, clean architecture, event-driven architecture, high availability, scalability, idempotency, retries, reconciliation

Cloud & operations: Kafka, Docker, Jenkins, CI/CD, AWS, Azure, Kibana, logging, monitoring, automated testing, incident response, security, data privacy, technical leadership, cross-functional collaboration, code reviews, JIRA

EDUCATION

BE, Information Technology | Chandigarh University, India | 2019 - 2023